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Is there a way to go from a Typst Document to a CSV file? self.typst

Submitted 1 day ago by SignumFunction

In short: is there a way to go from a Typst Document to a CSV file?

- Typst --> CSV, or
- Typst --> JSON --> CSV

I make multiple-choice questions in the Canvas LMS (learning management system), but I would like to avoid typing in questions directly into the LMS individually. A teacher can upload a CSV file into the LMS, but I would rather draft and make a collection of questions in a document rather than a spreadsheet. For example,

```
+ What is the capital of Estonia?  
  + Tallinn  
  + Helsinki  
  + Vilnius  
  + Riga  
  + Warsaw  
  
+ What is the capital of Latvia?  
  + Riga  
  + Helsinki  
  + Vilnius  
  + Tallinn  
  + Warsaw
```

would be converted to

What is the capital of Estonia?	Tallinn	Helsinki	Vilnius	Riga
What is the capital of Latvia?	Riga	Helsinki	Vilnius	Tallinn

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⬆️ [-] **Lightsheik** 13 points 21 hours ago

⬇️ Typst is not the tool for this. You should look into other structured file formats like toml, and write in a way that's easy to convert to csv.

Example: ```toml [[users]] id = 1 name = "Alice" age = 30

[[users]] id = 2 name = "Bob" age = 25

Can be converted to csv like: csv id,name,age
1,Alice,30 2,Bob,25 ```

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⬆️ [-] **PityUpvote** 5 points 21 hours ago

⬇️ Have you considered yaml or toml? It should be easier to jerry-rig those to convert to csv as they're machine trainer m readable. Nothing about what you're doing seems typst specific to me.

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⬆️ [-] **Average-Duck** 3 points 20 hours ago

⬇️ You could write a program in your language of choice to read in the typst source, detect that indented list structure, and write it out in a new file in CSV format.

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⬆️ [-] **it_aint_tony_bennett** 3 points 17 hours ago*

⬇️ It sounds like you have a bunch of pre-existing typst files with MC questions already typed into them.

If that's the case, then I'd write a python script to read those .typ files and make the CSV that way.

Otherwise, you are trying to make a Ferrari (typst) behave like a school bus.

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↑ [-] Silly-Freak 4 points 1 hours ago

↓ I agree with others that you should structure this the other way round of possible, but strictly speaking you can not produce whatever file you want with Typst:

<https://typst.app/docs/reference/model/asset/>

You need to enable the bundle experimental feature and use bundle export to use it, though. I showed a snippet for that here: <https://forum.typst.app/t/discussion-lobbying-for-typst-adoption-by-publishers/5930/28?u=ensko>

But first you'd have to extract the information from your content. It's much easier to start with structured data.

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↑ [-] Sermuns 2 points 1 day ago

↓ Not sure. Is there anything stopping you from creating the questions in CSV from the start then consuming them in Typst? <https://typst.app/docs/reference/data-loading/>

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↑ [-] SignumFunction [S] 3 points 21 hours ago

↓ That's the opposite direction that I want to use, especially if

- there are hundreds of multiple-choice questions
- answer choices could be whole paragraphs or math

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↑ [-] Sermuns 4 points 20 hours ago

↓ I see.

typst 0.15 added bundle exporting. Maybe it can export Typst data structures to structured data files?

<https://typst.app/blog/2026/typst-0.15/#bundle-export>

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↑ [-] ManuelRodriguez331 2 points 11 hours ago

↓ Agree, external csv files are shown in the document but not the other way around. Here is a short snippet how to do so with question answer pairs in a table.

```
---main.typ---
#let data = json("data.json")

#table(
  columns: (auto,auto),
  ..data.map(item => (
    item.question,
    item.answer,
```

```
)).flatten()
)

---data.json---
[
{
  "question": "What is the capital of Estonia?",
  "answer": "+Tallinn +Helsinki +Vilnius +Riga +Warsa
},
{
  "question": "What is the capital of Latvia?",
  "answer": "+Riga +Helsinki +Vilnius +Tallinn +Warsa
}
]
```

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↑ [-] **wangfugui98** 2 points 15 hours ago

↓ You need to change the toolset order. Use CSV (or YAML, TOML, JSON as others have mentioned) to describe the structured data and then use Typst to generate the output (Typst does have built-in support for all of the formats).

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↑ [-] **Basic-Brick6827** 1 point 17 hours ago

↓ Typst is made for formatting, why would you use it just to type structured data?

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↑ [-] **SignumFunction** [S] 1 point 10 hours ago

↓ Right. It is easy for a teacher to *type* multiple-choice questions into Typst (literally using plus signs). The familiar document setting allows for other text editing ease (e.g. copy and paste)

As others have suggested, I could then make a text parser to convert to TOML for structured data

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